Architecture Development Method Phase (Architecture Vision)

TOGAF ADM — Phase A

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Subject: Information Architecture (M.Tech) | Session: 2026–27

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What is Enterprise Architecture?

EA is a blueprint that aligns an organization's IT systems with its business goals.



EA fills this gap — the bridge between business strategy and technology

- **IT and business work in silos**
- **Systems miss real needs**
- **Money is wasted**

What is TOGAF?

The Open Group Architecture Framework — the most widely used EA framework, used by 80%+ of Fortune 500 companies.

1

ADM

Architecture Development Method — the process

2

Content Framework

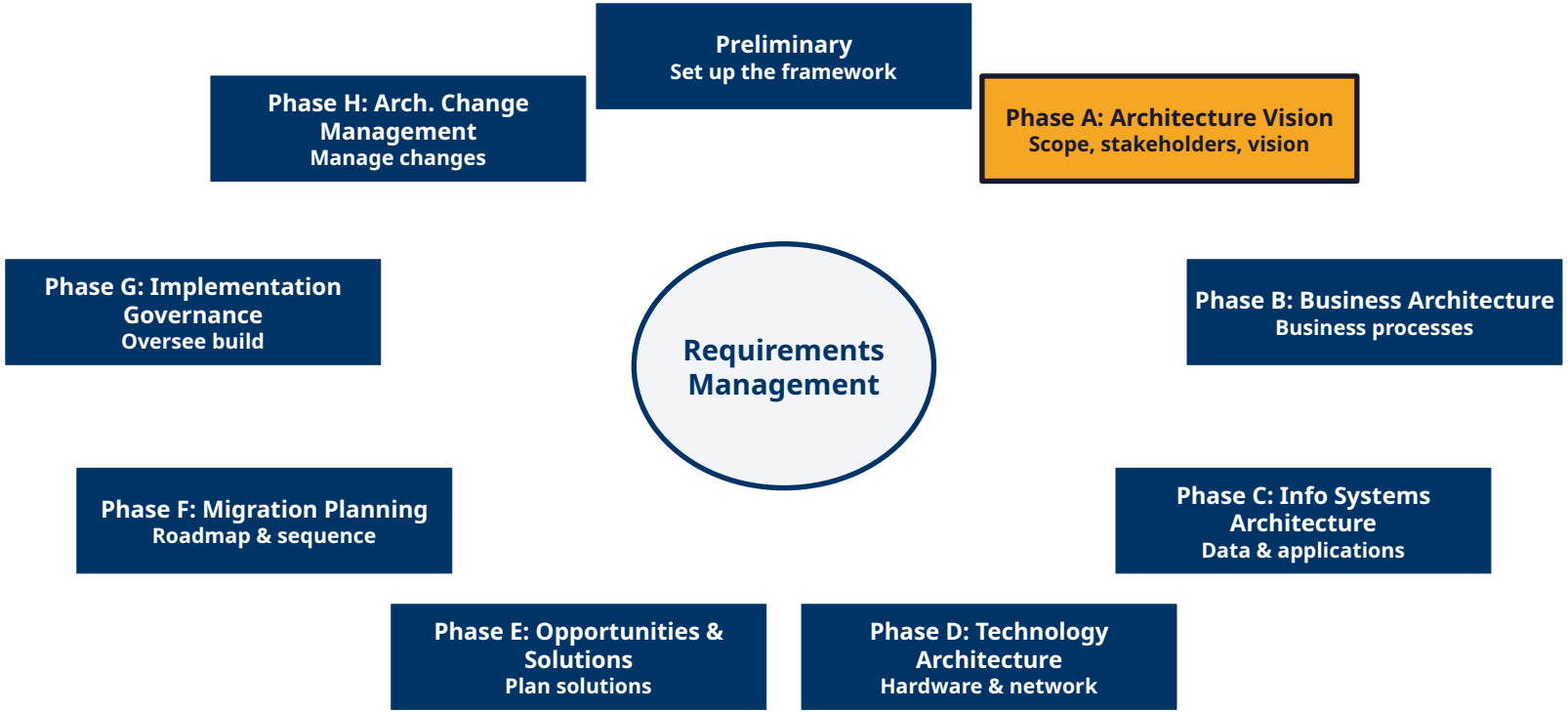
Architecture Content Framework — what to produce

3

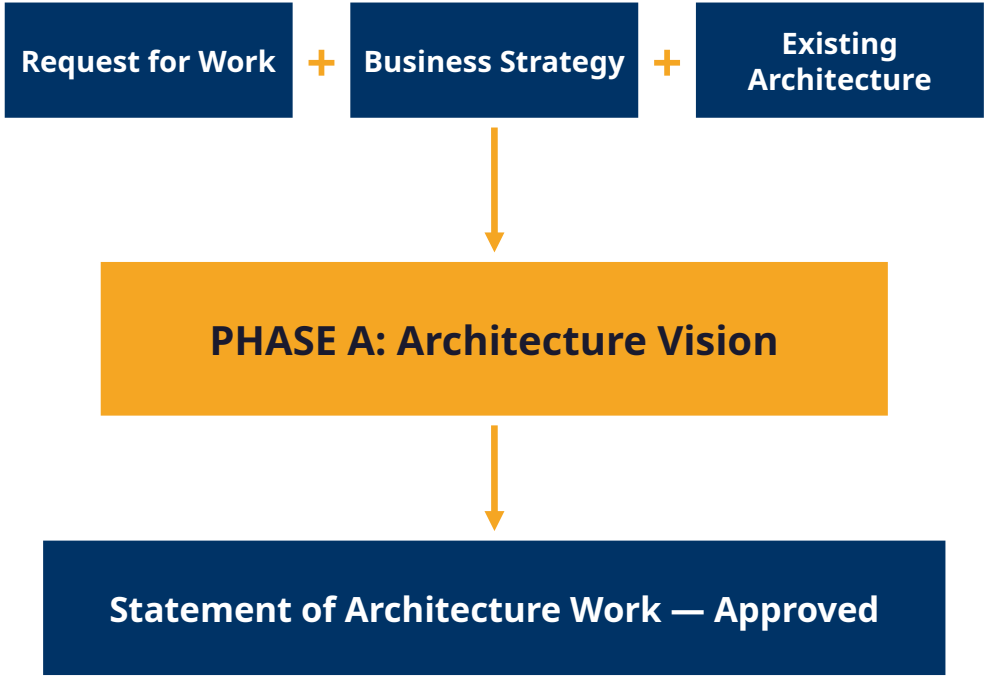
Continuum

Enterprise Continuum — where to store and reuse assets

ADM Cycle — All Phases



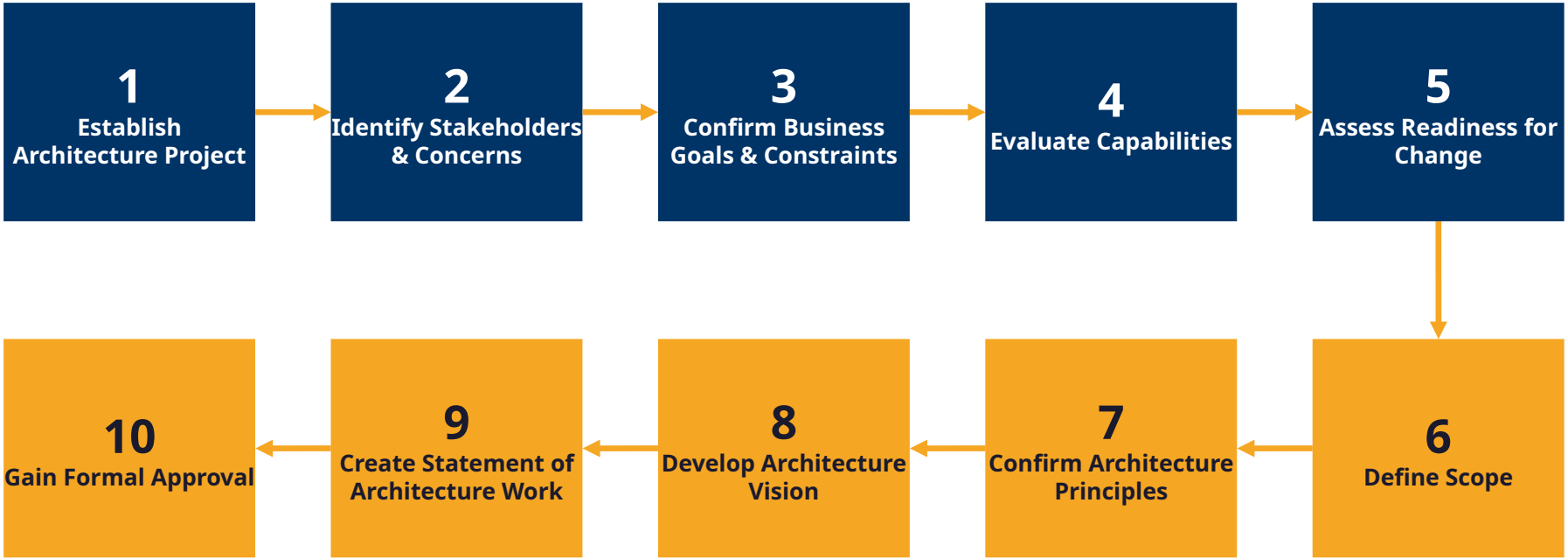
Phase A: Architecture Vision — What & Why



Purpose

- First and most important step of every ADM cycle
- Establish scope, identify stakeholders, define the high-level vision and get formal approval
- Answers: "What are we trying to achieve, for whom, and why?"

Steps Inside Phase A

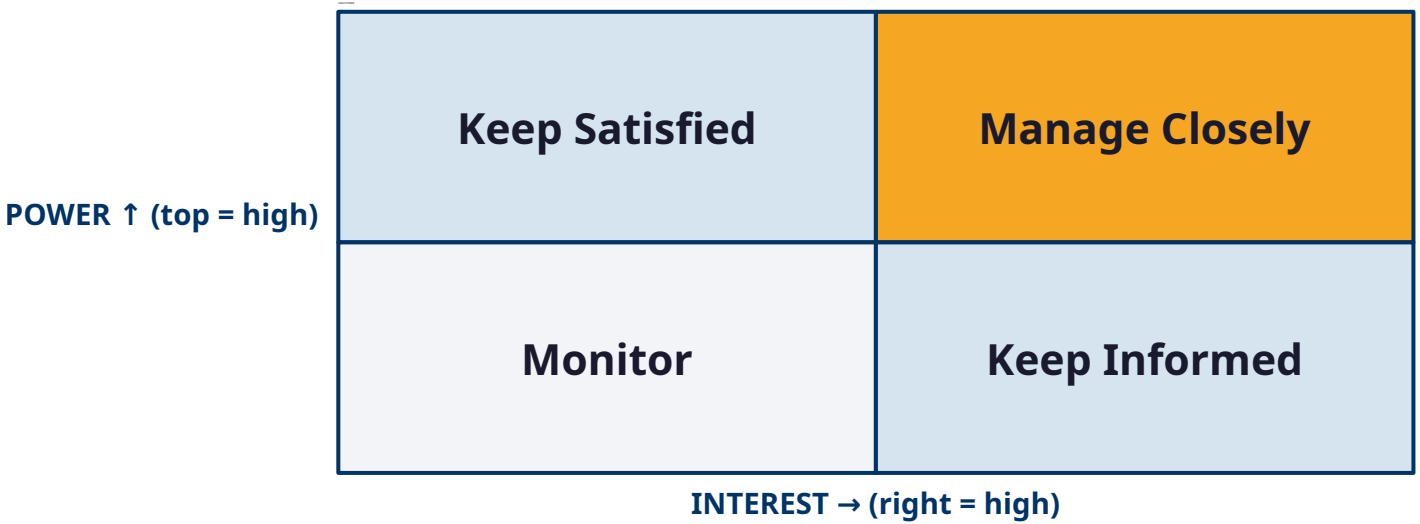


Key Outputs & Deliverables of Phase A

Deliverable	What It Is	Purpose
Statement of Architecture Work	Formal document: scope, plan, timeline	Get approval to proceed
Architecture Vision Document	High-level picture of target state	Align stakeholders
Stakeholder Map	Who is affected and how	Plan communication
Business Principles	Rules that guide decisions	Decision-making
Approved Request for Work	Authorization from sponsor	Official green light

Stakeholder Management

Stakeholder = anyone affected by or interested in the architecture



Tip: Identify who can BLOCK the project (High Power) and who is MOST AFFECTED (High Interest). Tool 2: RACI Matrix — Responsible, Accountable, Consulted, Informed.

Architecture Vision Document

The MAIN OUTPUT of Phase A — a shared understanding document, not a detailed design.

1 Problem Description

What problem we are solving

2 Business Objectives

What success looks like

3 Scope & Constraints

Boundaries and limitations

4 High-Level Capability Map

What the system must be able to do

5 Risks & Assumptions

What could go wrong

6 Key Performance Indicators

How we measure success

Inputs vs. Outputs of Phase A

INPUTS

- Architecture Reference Materials
- Business Strategy & Goals
- Request for Architecture Work
- Organization Structure & Culture
- Existing Architecture (if any)

PHASE A

OUTPUTS

Statement of Architecture Work ✓
Architecture Vision Document ✓
Refined Architecture Principles ✓
Stakeholder Map & Comms Plan ✓
Tailored ADM Process ✓

Case Study: Digital Government Portal

Phase A Step	What Happened
Request for Work	Cabinet approved IT transformation initiative
Stakeholders	Ministers, IT dept, citizens, vendors, data officers
Business Goal	Reduce service delivery time by 60% in 2 years
Scope	12 departments, 3-year rollout, budget ₹500 Cr
Constraints	Legacy systems, data privacy law, limited IT staff
Architecture Vision	Unified digital portal + centralized identity system
Output	Statement of Architecture Work approved by CIO

Note: This is an illustrative example to show Phase A in practice.

Challenges in Phase A

Challenge	Solution
Unclear business requirements	Structured workshops & interviews with stakeholders
Too many stakeholders, conflicting views	Use Power-Interest grid to prioritize
Scope keeps expanding (scope creep)	Define boundaries clearly in Statement of Architecture Work
Resistance from teams afraid of change	Involve stakeholders early, show benefits
No senior sponsor / executive support	Phase A CANNOT proceed — escalate immediately

Conclusion + References

1

Phase A is the foundation — no vision = no direction

2

Stakeholder management is as important as technical work

3

Statement of Architecture Work is the formal output

4

TOGAF is a guide, not a rigid rule

5

Architecture Vision is "What & Why" — not "How"

References
TOGAF Standard Version 9.2, The Open Group, 2018
Harrison, R. (2011). TOGAF 9 Foundation Study Guide
Lankhorst, M. (2013). Enterprise Architecture at Work
The Open Group: www.opengroup.org/togaf